



MISSOURI HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
WITNESS APPEARANCE FORM

BILL NUMBER: HB 3253		DATE: 2/26/2026	
COMMITTEE: Special Committee on Property Tax Reform			
TESTIFYING: ☒ IN SUPPORT OF ☐ IN OPPOSITION TO ☐ FOR INFORMATIONAL PURPOSES			
WITNESS NAME			
INDIVIDUAL:			
WITNESS NAME: ARNIE C. "HONEST-ABE" DIENOFF-STATE PUBLIC ADVOCAT		PHONE NUMBER:	
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION NAME:		TITLE:	
ADDRESS:			
CITY:		STATE:	ZIP:
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE: In-Person		SUBMIT DATE: 2/26/2026 11:51 PM

THE INFORMATION ON THIS FORM IS PUBLIC RECORD UNDER CHAPTER 610, RSMo.

This Bill is a great start. This Property-Tax Reform NEEDS to be Non-Partisan in nature.



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WITNESS NAME			
REGISTERED LOBBYIST:			
WITNESS NAME: COLE ARREOLA-KARR		PHONE NUMBER: 417-861-7418	
REPRESENTING: MISSOURI SPECIAL DISTRICTS ASSOCIATION		TITLE:	
ADDRESS: 1080 NW OUTER ROAD			
CITY: BLUE SPRINGS		STATE: MO	ZIP: 65015
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE:	SUBMIT DATE: 2/26/2026 12:00 AM	
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WITNESS NAME			
INDIVIDUAL:			
WITNESS NAME: SARAH BERRY		PHONE NUMBER:	
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION NAME:		TITLE:	
ADDRESS:			
CITY:		STATE:	ZIP:
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE: Written		SUBMIT DATE: 2/26/2026 7:38 AM
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HB 3253 is not reform — it is structural instability disguised as modernization.

This bill rewires Missouri’s entire property tax framework at once: reassessment formulas, levy calculations, appeal procedures, reimbursement structures, senior tax freezes, electronic notice mandates, installment payment systems, and county funding mechanisms — all in a single sweeping rewrite.

That is not prudent governance. That is policy overreach.

It shifts financial risk onto counties, school districts, and local services while promising state reimbursement that is merely “subject to appropriation” — the most unreliable phrase in statute. When the state fails to fund it, local governments will absorb the hit.

It creates a patchwork of five-percent counties, zero-percent counties, credit resets, levy recalculations, CPI caps, and ballot mandates that will invite confusion, litigation, and unequal treatment across the state.

Complexity is not transparency. It is chaos.

It expands administrative burdens on assessors while tightening compliance threats through the auditor and attorney general. It increases state oversight while increasing local liability.

That is contradiction, not clarity.

MOST concerning: it embeds permanent structural tax constraints into statute without guaranteeing permanent funding replacement.

That is how you starve essential services over time — slowly, quietly, and politically safely.

Responsible legislators do not gamble with the stability of school funding, county operations, and long-term tax structures for the sake of a headline.

**This bill is too broad, too unstable, and too risky.
Vote no.**



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WITNESS NAME			
REGISTERED LOBBYIST:			
WITNESS NAME: DAN HUTTON		PHONE NUMBER: 573-751-1712	
REPRESENTING: STATE TAX COMMISSION/STATE OMBUDSMAN		TITLE:	
ADDRESS: 9701 MISSOURI BOULEVARD, SUITE 100			
CITY: JEFFERSON CITY		STATE: MO	ZIP: 65109
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE:	SUBMIT DATE: 2/26/2026 12:00 AM	
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WITNESS NAME			
REGISTERED LOBBYIST:			
WITNESS NAME: MIKE LODEWEGEN		PHONE NUMBER: (573) 638-2692	
REPRESENTING: MISSOURI COUNCIL OF SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS		TITLE:	
ADDRESS: 3550 AMAZONAS DRIVE			
CITY: JEFFERSON CITY		STATE: MO	ZIP: 65109
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